

Reid Detmer Performance Analysis

By: Seth Richards



Reid Detmers
LHP, 6' 2"/210, Age: 27

IP	ERA	WHIP	PA	K%	BB%	K%-BB%	GB/FB
168.0	3.32	1.036	672.0	28.42	6.7	21.72	0.39

Background

Detmers was selected 10th overall in the first round of the 2020 Draft by the Angels out of the University of Louisville, where he was projected to be a mid-rotation starter in scouting reports. He debuted in the majors on August 1st, 2021, allowing 6 runs in 4.1 innings against the Athletics. He made 4 more starts that season, with a stint on the injury list sidelining him until September 2021.

Detmers returned to the Angels rotation to start the 2022 campaign, throwing 129 innings in 25 starts. His 3.77 ERA and 1.21 WHIP on the season showed promise, highlighted by a 108-pitch no-hitter against Tampa Bay on May 10th. The following two seasons were more difficult. Across 2023 and 2024, he struggled to find consistency from start to start. In a particularly rough stretch in May 2024, he allowed 26 earned runs in 24.2 innings, while never pitching through the 6th inning in any of his 5 starts that month. He was optioned to AAA Salt Lake in June 2024 and wasn't recalled until September that season. His struggles continued, however, with back-to-back starts giving up 7 runs.

The Angels took a different approach with Detmers in 2025. He worked exclusively out of the bullpen, appearing in 61 games with a 3.96 ERA. 12 of the 28 earned runs he allowed this year came within a 3 game rough stretch from April 30th to May 7th. Outside of that week, he was one of the Angels' most reliable relievers.

In 2026, Detmers returned to the rotation and has not looked back. He's started a career-high 29 games this season and thrown 168 innings to a 3.32 ERA and 191 strikeouts at the time of this writing. This past August, he threw 30 innings across 5 starts and allowed only 5 runs, one of the best months of his career. A 3.03 FIP and 4.24 SO/BB are also career highs,

showcasing his ability to keep runners off the bases, which had been a struggle in previous years.

In this analysis, I want to explore his arsenal and what he's doing well to have this resurgence in his career. The data in this report is taken from MLB Statcast using the Python package pybaseball. This data is updated through September 8th, 2026. I've included the code used to generate the charts and tables I created to help highlight Detmers' strengths.

First Impressions

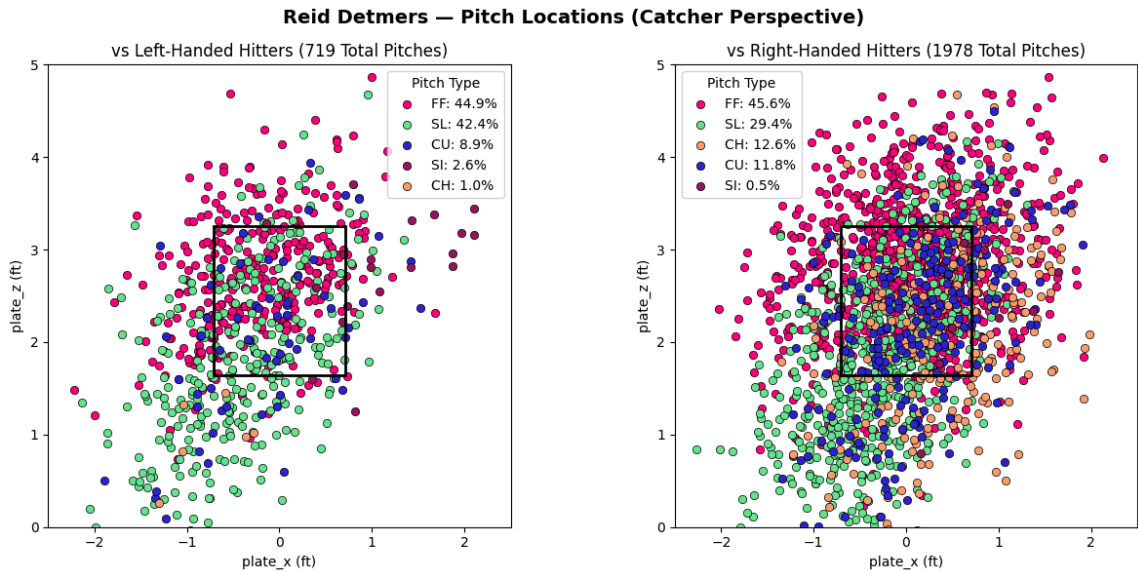
Throughout the several game I have watched of Detmers this season, here were the biggest takeaways I've had.

1. Excellent Command: Detmers was consistently hitting his spots, working efficiently through counts, which allows him to go deep into games with a high pitch count.
2. Weak Contact: Despite having strikeout stuff, he finds other ways to get outs to limit lengthy at-bats. In his August 28th start against the Phillies, only 2 of the 21 Balls In Play were classified as Solid Contact according to Statcast.
3. Curveball Usage: The curveball his not his most frequent pitch, but its usage in different counts stands out. Hitters are noticeably taking the pitch for a strike, a pattern the data below confirms.

Pitch Location by Batter Handedness

First up, let's get a sense of what Detmers throws. The chart below shows the locations of Detmers' pitches against left-handed and right-handed hitters. Two items immediately jump out from these charts. The first is his arsenal against lefties. His approach against LHH is very straightforward: fastballs in and around the top parts of the zone, then sliders low and away from the batter. 87.1% of the pitches he threw fall into this bucket.

The second is his use of the curveball against RHH. There's a ton of blue in the middle of the strike zone, which goes against what I would typically expect from a pitcher. I think of curveballs as the pitch you get players to chase, but Detmers seems to be challenging hitters with it. How successful is this approach?



The "Not So Secret" Secret Weapon

As it turns out, Detmers has had some great success with his curveball. He's thrown 285 total curveballs this season, which is not nearly as many as his 4-seam or slider, but hitters are having trouble with it. Let's take a look at the outcomes of Detmers throwing his curveball.

Reid Detmers Pitch Outcomes on Curveballs

description	count
called_strike	98
ball	85
foul	38
swinging_strike	36
hit_into_play	28
blocked_ball	8
swinging_strike_blocked	3
bunt_foul_tip	1

98 called strikes? That doesn't seem quite right. But sure enough, the numbers don't lie. Detmers' curveball is the most often called a strike in the league, by a good margin. Below are the pitchers who have the highest number of called strikes on their curveball this season. Everyone above Detmers on this list has at least 500 total curveballs thrown this season. The next closest is White Sox reliever Grant Taylor.

League Leaders in Called Strikes on Curveballs

player_name	called_strike	total_CU	called_strike_rate
Cantillo, Joey	131	763	17.17
Roupp, Landen	130	675	19.26
Williams, Gavin	120	604	19.87
Ashcraft, Braxton	119	638	18.65
Valdez, Framber	107	721	14.84
Arrighetti, Spencer	107	607	17.63
Detmers, Reid	98	297	33.0
Civale, Aaron	96	442	21.72
Yamamoto, Yoshinobu	93	331	28.1
Taylor, Grant	93	325	28.62

What really sets Detmers apart is the command of his curveball. He's thrown it for a called strike 13 more times than it has been called a ball. Turns out that's not so common this season either. He has the highest difference between called strikes and balls on curveballs this season. The table below is ranked by the highest difference.

Highest Difference between Called Strike and Ball on Curveball

player_name	called_strike	ball	difference	total_CU
Detmers, Reid	98	85	13	297
Walston, Blake	3	0	3	6
Corbin, Patrick	10	7	3	21
Englert, Mason	27	24	3	97
Peterson, Austin	2	0	2	2
Aldegheri, Sam	19	17	2	46
Harvey, Hunter	2	1	1	3
Casparius, Ben	5	4	1	16
Heasley, Jonathan	2	1	1	6
Gonzales, Marco	2	1	1	5

I'd call this pitch the "Not So Secret" Secret Weapon because it truly is unique. If you watch him throw it and pay attention to the hitter's reaction, you can start to understand why his called strike rate is so high. Out of the hand, it looks like that ball has no business landing near the strike zone. Yet he can land it in and around the edges of the zone, which helps discourage the hitter from even taking the bat off their shoulder.

One of my favorite pitches from his start against the Phillies was this pitch to Harper, where he immediately challenges the pitch after the umpire gives his strike call. [Harper ABS](#)

[Challenge \(Source: MLB Film Room\)](#) Now it makes sense why this pitch was graded high coming out of college. He doesn't throw it often, but when he does, he throws it with the intention of catching the hitter off guard and giving himself an advantage in the count.

The curveball doesn't just pass the eye test. Its movement stats back it up. The next table shows Detmers' movement stats on all his pitches, compared with a league-average left-handed pitcher for each pitch type. The `pfx_x` taken from Statcast represents the horizontal movement (in inches) from the catcher's perspective, and similarly, `pfx_z` represents the vertical movement. Negative values represent the glove-side run, and positive values represent the arm-side run for horizontal movement.

Reid Detmers Pitch Movement Profile Compared to League Averages

pitch_type	pfx_x_in_detmers	pfx_z_in_detmers	pfx_x_in_league	pfx_z_in_league	h_break_diff	v_break_diff
CH	11.95	10.89	13.86	4.8	-1.91	6.09
CU	-11.73	-14.71	-8.5	-10.31	-3.23	-4.4
FF	9.25	16.96	7.93	15.54	1.32	1.42
SI	14.9	13.73	15.28	7.65	-0.38	6.08
SL	-3.51	-3.88	-4.47	1.54	0.96	-5.42

The last part of Detmers curveball to mention is how hitters are reacting to it. Here we can see the count of each AB ending event on the curveball, which shows how hard it is to put this ball in play for a hit (8 of 51 events).

The `launch_speed_angle` is one of Statcast's methods for gauging exit velocity and launch angle, on the following scale, further illustrating how much trouble players have getting good contact off this pitch. Just 3 of the 26 curveballs put in play were barreled or hit with solid contact.

Plate Appearance Events on Curveballs

events	count
strikeout	18
field_out	16
walk	7
double	4
single	3
sac_fly	2
grounded_into_double_play	1
home_run	1
fielders_choice	1

Launch Speed Angle of Batted Curveballs

launch_speed	count
Flare/Burner	8
Under	7
Topped	7
Weak	3
Barrel	2
Solid Contact	1

The Best Pitch

His slider is his best all around pitch. From the movement table above, we can see that his slider has 5.42 more inches of downward break than a league-average left-handed slider does, which is part of what makes it so effective. In fact, it's one of the best strikeout pitches in the league. Below is a table of the individual pitches that have generated the most strikeouts so far this season, and Detmers sits at 8th with his slider, behind Chris Sale and Chase Burns sliders. Not bad company to be in. To illustrate the slider in action, here's how the at-bat ended to Bryce Harper. [Video Link Here to MLB Film Room](#)

Top 10 Strikeout Leaders by Pitch Type

player_name	pitch_type	strikeouts
Misiorowski, Jacob	FF	156
Luzardo, Jesús	ST	132
Burns, Chase	SL	120
Schlittler, Cam	FF	115
Sánchez, Cristopher	CH	113
Sale, Chris	SL	105
Nola, Aaron	KC	95
Detmers, Reid	SL	94
Cease, Dylan	SL	92
Messick, Parker	FF	90

The three tables below show the Swing, Whiff, and Chase rates Detmers gets compared to the rest of the league on his 3 most-used pitches. His slider clearly stands out as his best pitch compared to the rest of the league, with a fantastic chase rate. What's also interesting to look at here is the curveball. Detmers gets below-average swing and Chase percentages on the curveball, yet when the batter does swing, he is in the 74th percentile for whiffs. This is yet another signal that the curveball is tough for hitters to pick up and get a bat on.

Reid Detmers Curveball Profile vs. League

Metric	Reid Detmers	League_avg	Percentile
Swing%	35.7%	37.2%	40th
Whiff%	37.7%	26.6%	74th
Chase%	12.5%	14.9%	36th

Reid Detmers Slider Profile vs. League

Metric	Reid Detmers	League_avg	Percentile
Swing%	52.1%	46.7%	75th
Whiff%	35.3%	29.8%	65th
Chase%	22.9%	17.6%	80th

Reid Detmers 4-Seam Profile vs. League

Metric	Reid Detmers	League_avg	Percentile
Swing%	51.4%	47.5%	70th
Whiff%	21.6%	20.2%	57th
Chase%	12.7%	13.1%	50th

The slider is by far his best overall pitch. He's able to generate high whiff and chase rates compared to sliders across the league, and has a top Run Value on the pitch. Run Value was calculated by summing the change in run expectancy on each pitch, and Detmers' slider ranks 8th highest among all individual pitches.

Pitch Run Value Leaderboards

player_name	pitch_type	total_run_value	num_pitches	rv_per_100
Messick, Parker	FF	25.8	1065	2.42
Misiorowski, Jacob	FF	25.16	1549	1.62
Cease, Dylan	SL	24.95	827	3.02
McLean, Nolan	SI	24.82	893	2.78
Schlittler, Cam	FF	23.86	1227	1.94
Luzardo, Jesús	ST	22.63	1093	2.07
Miles, Spencer	SI	19.12	594	3.22
Detmers, Reid	SL	18.3	887	2.06
Ureña, Walbert	CH	16.85	741	2.27
deGrom, Jacob	SL	16.24	852	1.91

Let's take another look at what hitters are doing to the slider. Only seven extra-base hits on the pitch and six balls in play that hitters made solid contact or barreled.

Plate Appearance Events on Sliders

events	count
strikeout	94
field_out	82
single	33
walk	13
force_out	4
double	4
home_run	3
grounded_into_double_play	2
double_play	1
sac_bunt	1
hit_by_pitch	1
field_error	1

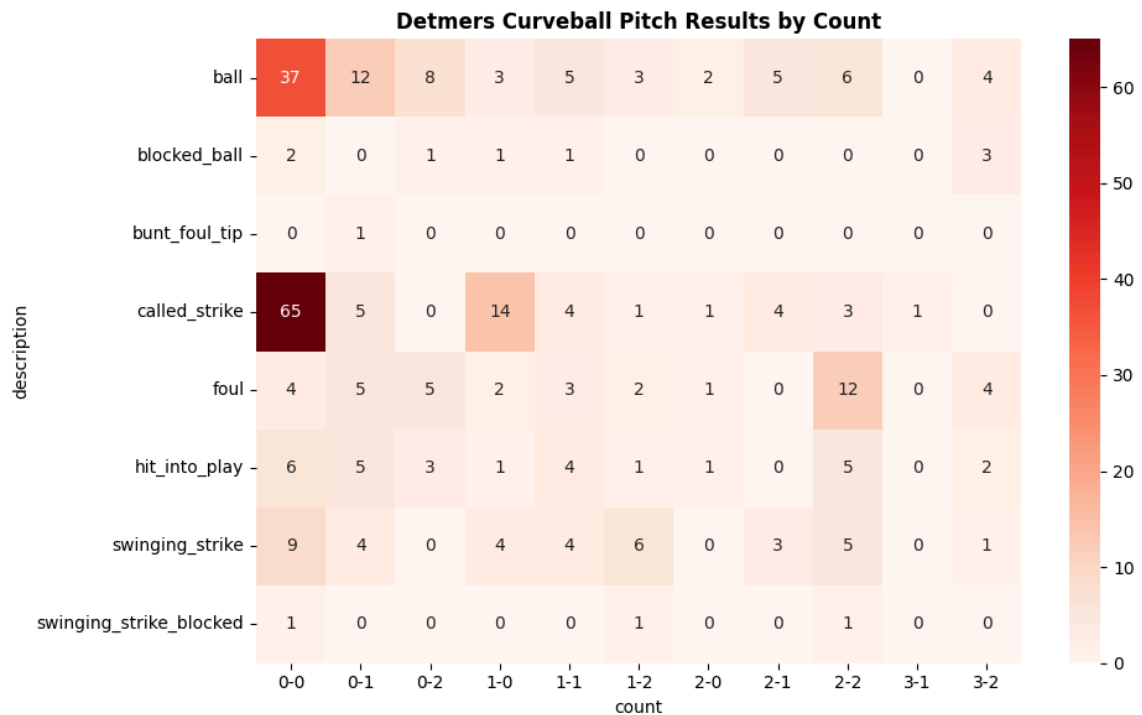
Launch Speed Angle of Batted Sliders

launch_speed	count
Topped	45
Flare/Burner	37
Under	33
Weak	10
Barrel	4
Solid Contact	2

The curveball and slider alone this season are a large part of Detmers' success. His slider is an excellent weapon to get weak contact or a whiff, while his curveball can help him steal a strike when needed. I think the next step in his development would be to improve his fastball offerings. There's nothing inherently wrong with his 4-seam, but it certainly doesn't play as well as his breaking pitches. If anything it's the only pitch in his arsenal hitters are able to handle. He has a 5 Run Value on the 4-seam, and 10 of the 17 home runs he's given up this season have been on the fastball.

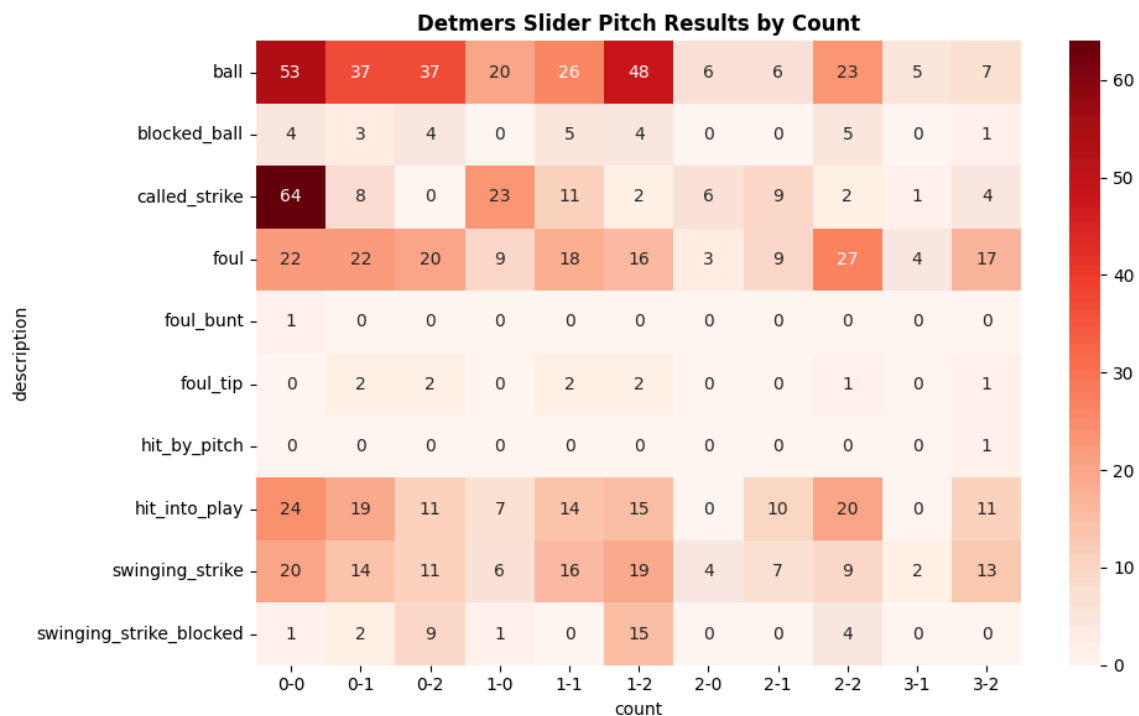
Looking at Pitch Usage in Different Counts

The last topic I want to investigate is when Detmers throws his pitches and in which counts. The following 3 heatmaps show the initial count at which a pitch was thrown and the outcome of that pitch. For example, in a 0-0 count, Detmers has thrown his curveball 37 times, and the result has been a ball. The Totals by count table are there to help illustrate how often he throws a pitch type in a certain count.



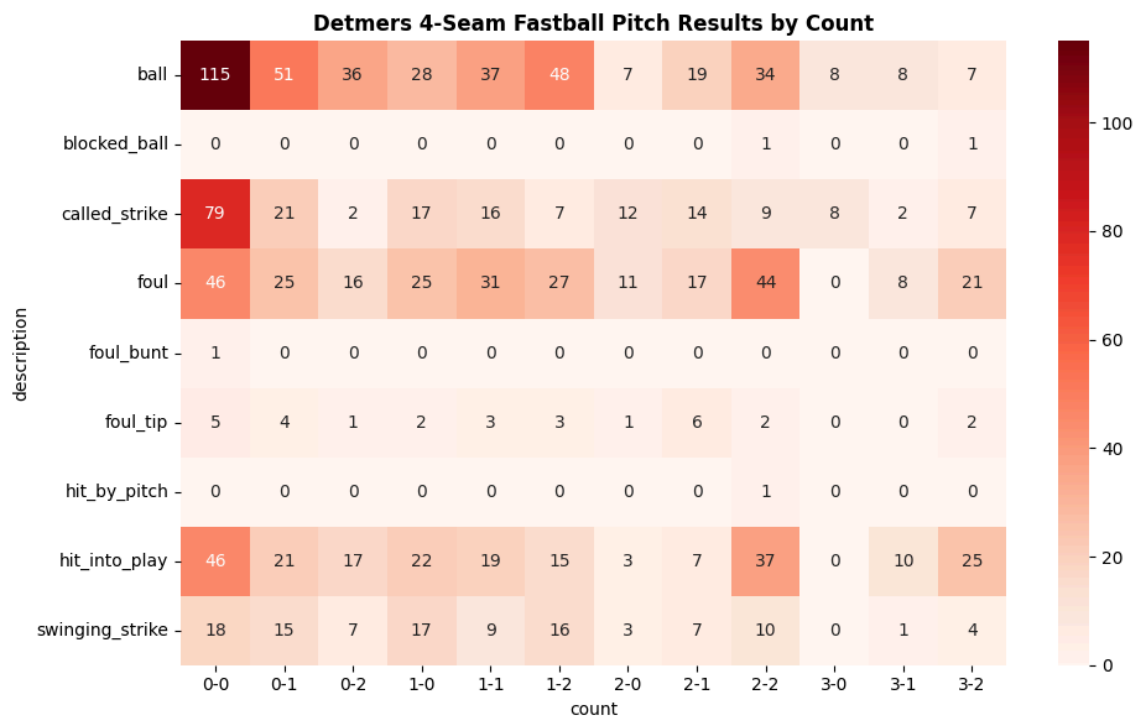
Detmers Curveball Totals by Count

count	Total Pitches	Situation Rate
0-0	124	41.75
0-1	32	10.77
0-2	17	5.72
1-0	25	8.42
1-1	21	7.07
1-2	14	4.71
2-0	5	1.68
2-1	12	4.04
2-2	32	10.77
3-1	1	0.34
3-2	14	4.71



Detmers Slider Totals by Count

count	Total Pitches	Situation Rate
0-0	189	21.31
0-1	107	12.06
0-2	94	10.6
1-0	66	7.44
1-1	92	10.37
1-2	121	13.64
2-0	19	2.14
2-1	41	4.62
2-2	91	10.26
3-1	12	1.35
3-2	55	6.2



Detmers 4-Seam Fastball Totals by Count

count	Total Pitches	Situation Rate
0-0	310	25.31
0-1	137	11.18
0-2	79	6.45
1-0	111	9.06
1-1	115	9.39
1-2	116	9.47
2-0	37	3.02
2-1	70	5.71
2-2	138	11.27
3-0	16	1.31
3-1	29	2.37
3-2	67	5.47

What still jumps out is the ability to throw his curveball for strikes. Keep in mind that a strike in these tables is split between several different outcomes, but the usage is still fascinating to me. He uses his curveball early in counts (0-0, 1-0) to try to get ahead or even with the batter. He can then leverage that favorable count to put batters away with his slider. I also

notice his fastball, particularly the 115 balls in a 0-0 count. Honing in on his command of the fastball early in counts could help him get in a favorable count so that he can go to those offspeed pitches without having to worry about falling behind.

Conclusion

- His pitch mix is simple, yet effective. He has an unconventional use of his curveball to catch hitters off guard, instead of trying to get chases. The slider is one of the best strikeout pitches in baseball and seems to complement his curveball, giving him 2 elite breaking ball options in his arsenal. Both pitches have a sub .200 batting average, according to Baseball Savant.
- He has excellent command of his arsenal, which allows him to work through innings efficiently. He's not afraid to throw his pitches for strikes and challenge hitters.
- I am curious how he will develop further and what the next step of his evolution will be. Increasing his sinker usage to play off his fastball might bolster what his fastball has to offer.

Detmers has started to show, with his aggressive pitching style and excellent command of his arsenal, that he can be a top arm in this league. His emergence this season has been a bright spot for the Angels, and I hope he continues to prove that their investment in him was worthwhile.